

countertrend move (bear market, upward breakout). That would be clearer with the missing bear market, down breakout column.

Days to ultimate high or low. The rise in bear markets is 30% faster than the rise in bull markets (you find that by taking the ratio of gain to time). The downward breakout in bull markets drops at the same speed as the bull market rises. In other chart patterns, we see bear market velocity about twice as fast as in bull markets.

Table 73.2 General Statistics

Description	Bull Market, Up Breakout	Bear Market, Up Breakout	Bull Market, Down Breakout
Number found	583	176	277
Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence	49% R, 51% C	52% R, 48% C	42% R, 58% C
Reversal, continuation performance	38% R, 39% C	27% R, 25% C	-13% R, -14% C
Average rise or decline	38%	26%	-14%
Standard & Poor's 500 change	10%	2%	-1%
Days to ultimate high or low	160	82	59
How many change trend?	46%	47%	27%

How many change trend? This is a count of how many wedges see price move more than 20% after the breakout. For upward breakouts, I like to see values above 50%, but wedges can't meet that benchmark (but two columns come close). Even downward breakouts fall short of the average posted by other chart pattern types.

What does this mean? Let me tell you. I was hoping this row would separate patterns that trend from those that do not. Perhaps it does. We